

SHIMIT AMIN For directing arguably India's best idea film of the year, and showing how a simple thought, if handled well, can successfully achieve both popular and critical acclaim

JAIDEEP SAHNI For scripting a story which raised critical systemic questions, yet at the same time managed to entertain and inspire the nation, making Chak De a virtual mass inspirational slogan.



Shimit & Jaideep - Entertainment

"Film-making is perhaps one of the most collaborative things mankind has ever invented. So we are aware that we stand here as representatives of two groups of wonderful people who touched our work and made it what it is... Maharaj Krishan Kaushik for opening your camp, your training, and your heart and the hearts of your players to us, and for showing us what patriotism team spirit and determination is in every day's work and not grand concepts..."

And of course all the unsung heroes of daily activities... the backbone, the real centre forward for the team Shah Rukh Khan; whose experience is far superior than ours... So he helped us incredibly and without him we wouldn't be here..."



Vishwanathan Anand - Sports

For being one of India's greatest ambassador of sportsmanship and now the undisputed World Champion in Chess, thereby making it a hugely popular sport in the country.

"I would like to thank CNN-IBN for making me the Indian of the Year. As you know 2007 was a very special year for me. So it's just a perfect year and I think this award really caps it and makes it a nice finish for 2007 which will be a very special year for me..."



E. Sreedharan - Public Service

For showing the country how a strong work ethic and quiet discipline ensures unprecedented success and timely implementation of large projects. In the process, he has changed the face of mass urban transportation, not just in the

national capital, but also offered a model for the rest of the country to emulate, and for millions of commuters to benefit from. From the Konkan railway to the metro project, he has spent a lifetime making the seemingly impossible come true.

"This is a very proud moment for me. It's a great honour, it's a great recognition to receive the CNN-IBN award The Indian of the Year for Public Service. We are happy that whatever we have done has been recognized by the country at large and in fact the award that I'm receiving today is the award for Delhi Metro Rail Corporation and not to me in person..."



Arun Sarin - Global Indian

For piloting one of the largest foreign direct investments in 2007 and ensuring Indian cellular operators are being forced to raise their bar with the entry of Vodafone, the world's largest mobile operator.

"I hope this award is an inspiration for young people because everything is possible. Work hard, push the envelope, and if this kid from Pachmarhi, Madhya Pradesh can do it, so can you! Cheers..."

Where will India's next generation of icons emerge from?



Mumbai Panel Discussion



Bengaluru Panel Discussion